

Ali Jafarzadeh

Ph.D. Candidate in Finance

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Education

University of Colorado Boulder, Leeds School of Business Expected 2028
Ph.D. in Business Administration, Finance

Tarbiat Modares University 2023
M.S. in Economics, Minor in Mathematics

University of Tehran 2019
B.S. in Mechanical Engineering (Food Machinery)

Research Interests

Corporate Finance; Innovation; Industrial Organization

Research

Working Paper

- *Innovation Dynamics and Acquisition Decisions* *Second-Year Paper*

Technological similarity helps determine a target's value to an acquirer, but this relationship evolves as firms innovate. Using semantic embeddings of patent portfolios, I study how both current technological distance and the history of technological convergence affect acquisition choices among otherwise similar targets.

Scheduled for presentation at the Financial Management Association Annual Meeting and the Southern Finance Association Annual Meeting, 2026.

Work in Progress

- *The Evolution of Firm Disclosure, 1920–1969* (with Diego Garcia)

Using Moody's Industrial Manuals, we study which accounting items firms disclosed, how disclosure varied across firms, and how reporting practices changed over time.

- *Access to Finance and Local Economic Growth, 1920–1969*

Using historical Moody's Government Manuals, this project studies how differences in local access to finance affect subsequent economic growth.

Teaching Experience

University of Colorado Boulder

Instructor

FNCE 3030: Investments and Portfolio Management Summer 2026
BCOR 2204: Principles of Financial Management Spring 2026, Spring 2027 (scheduled)

Teaching Assistant

FNCE 3030: Investments and Portfolio Management 2025

Tarbiat Modares University

Teaching Assistant

Graduate Econometrics 2022–2023

Honors and Fellowships

Graduate School Summer Fellowship, University of Colorado Boulder(7500\$)	2026
Hart Summer Fellowship, Leeds School of Business(3000\$)	2025
Ph.D. Fellowship, University of Colorado Boulder	2023–2028

Additional Training

High-Throughput Computing, Open Science Grid, University of Wisconsin–Madison	2025
Advanced Causal Inference Workshops, Northwestern University	2024
Comprehensive Data Science Bootcamp, University of Tehran	2021–2023

Technical Skills

Programming: Python, R, Stata, SQL, Linux

Data and Computational Methods: NLP, OCR, HTC, SLURM, HTCondor, Apptainer